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a and v are the parameters that characterize the JVP (see Fig. 2). In this paper, these parameters are denoted in terms of the value s assumed by the CSA during the cardiac cycle. The values of the CSA of the IJV in correspondence of the waves a , c , x , v and y , during the i -th cycle are indicated by the parameters a_i , c_i , x_i , v_i and y_i . These parameters are detected on the JVP trace by means of an algorithm based on the following definitions: $a_1 = \max(CSA(t)) : 0 < t < T$ $c_i = \max(CSA(t)) : t_{y_{i-1}} + t_{ya} - T_c < t < t_{y_i} + t_{ya} + T_c$ $c_i = \max(CSA(t)) : t_{a_i} + t_{ac} - T_c < t < t_{a_i} + t_{ac} + T_c$ $x_i = \min(CSA(t)) : t_{a_i} + t_{ax} - T_c < t < t_{a_i} + t_{ax} + T_c$ $v_i = \max(CSA(t)) : t_{x_i} + t_{xv} - T_c < t < t_{x_i} + t_{cx} + T_c$ $y_i = \min(CSA(t)) : t_{v_i} + t_{vy} - T_c < t < t_{v_i} + t_{vy} + T_c$ (1) Figure 1: The figure represents an illustrative sequence of three sonograms from a video-clip obtained by a transverse ultrasound scan of the IJV. In each picture it is visible the IJV (ellipses), the common carotid artery (circular) and the ECG trace (blue line). The active phase of the ECG is indicated by the red cursor. Below, it shows the IJV CSA trace obtained by